

**Supplement:** Omega-3 (fish oil) to reduce inflammation, especially if blood markers show elevated CRP or joint stress.

### Main Meal

This is the key pre-match fuelling meal — low in fibre, rich in clean carbohydrates and moderate protein, designed for slow energy release.

#### Indian options:

- ⌘ Jeera rice, dal tadka, sautéed carrots, cucumber
- ⌘ Khichdi with green peas and paneer
- ⌘ Idiyappam with mild vegetable stew

#### Continental options:

- ⌘ Grilled chicken or tofu with mashed potatoes and steamed vegetables
- ⌘ White rice with baked fish and courgette
- ⌘ Rice noodles with tofu in ginger-soy broth

**Caffeine:** Only allowed if the player has been genetically tested for caffeine metabolism.

### Pre-Match Meal

A light snack to top up energy stores without burdening the stomach.

- ⌘ Vegetable sandwich on sourdough with a slice of cheese
- ⌘ Peanut butter on toast with sliced banana

### Hydration

Hydration and muscle preparation are critical. A combination of:

- ⌘ Beetroot and watermelon juice with retained fibre
- ⌘ Branched-chain amino acids (BCAA)
- ⌘ Collagen peptides

This blend improves stamina, protects joints, and supports endurance. Players with certain COL5A1 gene variants benefit more from collagen due to weaker connective tissue. Protein selection (whey or plant-based) depends on food intolerance and gut reports.

### During the Match

Maintaining hydration and glucose levels is key. Players sip:

- ⌘ Lemon water with soaked chia seeds
- ⌘ Custom-formulated sports drinks (not energy drinks)
- ⌘ BCAA solution to support

muscle retention

### Innings Break

Refuelling is quick and efficient:

- ⌘ Whey/plant protein shake
- ⌘ One banana
- ⌘ One tablespoon peanut butter

This combination restores blood sugar and primes the muscles for the second innings.

### Post-Match Recovery

The 30-minute window after a match is crucial. Players can have:

- ⌘ Whey/plant protein isolate (40g)
- ⌘ Watermelon or pineapple slices for hydration and antioxidants

This supports muscle recovery and electrolyte balance.

### Late Dinner

Dinner is kept light and easy on the stomach to aid overnight digestion.

#### Indian options:

- ⌘ Jeera rice with mixed dal and sautéed carrots
- ⌘ Tomato, spinach, or broccoli soup
- ⌘ Steamed rice with bottle gourd sabzi and curd

#### Continental options:

- ⌘ Sweet potato mash with steamed chicken
- ⌘ Broccoli soup with toast
- ⌘ Stir-fried vegetables with tofu

### Night Recovery Routine

- ⌘ Magnesium glycinate to support deep sleep
- ⌘ Chamomile tea to wind down
- ⌘ Probiotic to rebalance gut flora after physical exertion

### Practice Day Routine

- ⌘ Start with jeera water + glutamine + L-carnitine
- ⌘ Fasted cardio or mobility drills (30 mins) to activate metabolism

#### Breakfast:

- ⌘ Idli with sambar, poha
- ⌘ Muesli with almond milk

#### Training Nutrition:

- ⌘ During: Lemon water + sabja seeds + BCAA
- ⌘ After: Whey/plant protein shake + 2 dates

#### Lunch:

- ⌘ Brown rice or quinoa with dal/tofu curry and sautéed vegetables

- ⌘ Grilled chicken with sweet potato mash

#### Evening Snack:

- ⌘ Beetroot-watermelon juice with collagen and BCAA

#### Post-Training Recovery:

- ⌘ Whey/plant protein shake + dried blueberries

#### Dinner:

- ⌘ Light soup + salad + sautéed vegetables
- ⌘ Sleep routine with magnesium glycinate + probiotic

### Travel Day Routine

#### Morning mobility:

- ⌘ Gentle walk or stretch to improve circulation

#### Hydration:

- ⌘ Jeera water + spirulina

#### Breakfast:

- ⌘ Oats with fruit or a smoothie

#### In-flight snacking:

- ⌘ Soaked almonds, walnuts, prunes, protein bar

#### Post-arrival:

- ⌘ Coconut water + lemon water + BCAA

#### Dinner:

- ⌘ Brown rice + dal + steamed vegetables
- ⌘ Magnesium before bed to help reset circadian rhythm

### Off-Day Recovery Routine

**Morning:** Light yoga, swim, or a 30-minute walk

**Breakfast:** Oats + berries + nuts

**Lunch:** Grilled chicken or tofu with quinoa salad

**Evening:** Green or chamomile tea

**Dinner:** Soup + brown rice + dal

**Night:** Magnesium glycinate + probiotic

### Why This Plan Works

Every recommendation is backed by science and tailored to the player:

- ⌘ Genetic tests determine how fast players metabolise caffeine, fats, or collagen.

- ⌘ Gut microbiome reports guide food choices that reduce bloating and improve nutrient absorption.

⌘ Blood markers show nutrient deficiencies, inflammation levels, liver stress. No two players are alike. That's why this isn't about trendy diets — it's about data-driven performance. At the IPL level, players are already skilled and fit. The difference between good and great comes down to recovery, consistency, and mindset — all of which are influenced by nutrition.